

India to focus on manufacturing in 25 electronic segments

India has decided its focus areas for boosting the domestic electronics manufacturing. The country has zeroed in on a list of 25 electronic segments including mobile phones, flat panel TVs and notebooks, where it will focus on to begin with.

Electronics and IT secretary, J. Satyanarayana, says, "Year of 2014 should be year of Made in India. It makes commercial, economic sense to make these products and components in India. If we are able to focus on these 20-25 products, then there should be substantial change in electronics industry by December 2014." Satyanarayana was speaking at an event organised by IESA.

Local sourcing of electronics not mandatory for defence sector: Revised PMA

As per the proposal made by the Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY) to the Union Cabinet, local sourcing of electronics will be compulsory for government departments, barring the defence ministry, and this would be valid for 10 years. The proposal has also left the private sector out of its ambit. The revised preferential market access (PMA) policy makes it mandatory to source sensitive telecom and electronic equipment and technology from the domestic industry.

The government is trying its best to boost domestic manufacturing as India's electronics imports are expected to reach US\$ 300 billion by 2020, which will amount to more than the total oil imports by that time.

Prantij to house new semiconductor unit

Prantij in Sabarkantha district has been picked as the location for setting up of

GR Sakura design contestants awarded

An electronic design contest based on Gadget Renesas (GR) Sakura board was organised recently by Renesas Electronics in partnership with EFY as managing partner and Element 14 as logistics partner.

About 580 registrations were received from NITs, IITs, Anna University, Delhi Technological University and from companies like Honeywell, TCS, Bosch and many small design houses. Of these 100 contestants were provided the GR Sakura board for actual development. After a series of evaluations, Renesas invited top 20 contestants to showcase their projects on December 3, 2013.

The first prize (₹ 150,000) was bagged by Army Institute of Technology, Pune, who designed 'magic glove hand gesture hardware controller.' The second prize (₹ 100,000) went to 'Sakura smart SOS system for vehicle crash detection and emergency response' designed by Marwadi Education Foundation, Rajkot. Third prize (₹ 50,000) was won by IIEEE, Kolkata for creating an 'advanced home signal warning system for train protection.' Some more awards were given under different categories.

Awards

CEAMA re-elects Anirudh Dhoot as its president

The Consumer Electronics and Appliances Manufacturers Association (CEAMA) has re-elected Anirudh Dhoot as its president for the third consecutive year. He is also the director of Videocon Industries.

S.K. Sharma is the new CMD of BEL

S.K. Sharma has taken charge as the chairman and managing director (CMD) of Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL). Sharma served BEL in various capacities since 1978. He was responsible for the successful execution of large land-mobile electronic warfare projects and the induction of advanced naval electronic support systems for the armed forces, a company press release said.

J. Satyanarayana, DeitY secy, to retire in April

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has extended the tenure of J. Satyanarayana as secretary in the Department of Electronics and Information Technology beyond March 13 to April 30, the date of his superannuation. A member of Indian Administrative Service from 1977 batch and AP cadre, J. Satyanarayana has been special chief secretary in the state of Andhra Pradesh.

In Focus



At a semiconductor unit at Marammalanagar, Chennai

a new semiconductor wafer fabrication (FAB) manufacturing facility in the state. Additional chief secretary of the state's industry department says that the facility is expected to attract more than ₹ 220,000 million investments in the region. Of this, ₹ 60,000 million will be invested by the central government.

Whilst speaking on the sidelines of the launch of Gujarat Knowledge Ap-